

Meridian Systems

Employee Handbook

Revision 4 — effective 1 March 2025

Supersedes Revision 3 of 12 June 2023

1. Purpose and scope

This handbook sets out the working conditions, entitlements and obligations that apply to all permanent and fixed-term employees of Meridian Systems Ltd. It does not apply to contractors engaged through a statement of work, whose terms are governed by that agreement instead.

Where this handbook conflicts with an individual employment contract, the contract prevails. Where it conflicts with statutory law, the law prevails and the affected clause is treated as void without invalidating the remainder of the handbook.

2. About Meridian Systems

Meridian Systems designs and maintains industrial telemetry hardware for water utilities. The company was incorporated in 2011 and employs 148 people across three sites: the head office and manufacturing floor in Bellhaven, a firmware engineering office in Coriston, and a field services depot in Underwood.

The company is privately held. Roughly 31 percent of shares are allocated to the employee share scheme described in section 9.

3. How to use this handbook

Questions about interpretation should be directed to People Operations at the Bellhaven site. Managers may not grant exceptions to any policy in this handbook without written approval from a director; verbal assurances are not binding on the company.

4. Working hours and location

4.1 Core hours

The standard working week is 38 hours. Core hours, during which employees are expected to be contactable, run from 10:00 to 15:00 local time. Outside core hours, employees may arrange their schedule as they see fit provided their weekly total is met and their team's commitments are covered.

4.2 Remote work

Office-based employees may work remotely up to three days per week. Manufacturing and field services roles are excluded from remote work for operational reasons, and receive the on-site allowance described in section 6.4 instead.

Fully remote arrangements require director approval and are reviewed every twelve months. An employee working remotely from outside the country for more than 21 consecutive days must notify People Operations in advance, as this may create tax obligations for the company.

4.3 Overtime

Overtime is not expected and is not routinely compensated for salaried staff. Where a director requests overtime in writing for a specific project, hourly-paid employees are compensated at 1.5 times the standard rate, rising to 2.0 times on public holidays.

4.4 Time recording

All employees record hours in the Kestrel timesheet system by 17:00 on the last working day of each week. Timesheets submitted more than fourteen days late may delay expense reimbursement in the same period.

5. Leave and time off

5.1 Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 22 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to public holidays. Entitlement accrues monthly and is prorated for part-time staff and for employees joining part-way through the year.

A maximum of 5 unused days may be carried into the following year. Carried days expire on 31 March and are not paid out if unused. Leave requests of more than five consecutive days should be submitted at least three weeks in advance.

5.2 Sick leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. Absences of three or more consecutive days require a medical certificate. Unused sick leave does not carry over and is not paid on termination.

5.3 Parental leave

The primary caregiver is entitled to 16 weeks of paid parental leave. The secondary caregiver is entitled to 4 weeks, which must be taken within six months of the birth or placement. Both entitlements require twelve months of continuous service at the expected date of leave.

Employees returning from parental leave may request a phased return at 60 percent of normal hours for the first four weeks at full pay.

5.4 Bereavement and other leave

Bereavement leave of 5 days is available for an immediate family member and 2 days for an extended family member. Study leave of up to 6 days per year is available where the course of study is relevant to the employee's role and has been approved in advance.

6. Expenses and travel

6.1 General principles

Employees are reimbursed for reasonable expenses necessarily incurred in the course of their duties. Receipts must be submitted within 14 days of the expense being incurred. Claims submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed except with director approval.

6.2 Approval thresholds

Amount	Approval required
Under 150	No pre-approval; receipt only
150 to 500	Line manager, before the expense
500 to 2,500	Department head, before the expense
Over 2,500	Director and finance, before the expense

6.3 Travel

Flights under six hours are booked in economy class. Flights over six hours may be booked in premium economy. Business class requires director approval regardless of duration.

The per diem for meals and incidentals is 45 currency units per day for domestic travel and 70 currency units per day for international travel. Per diem is paid without receipts; itemised meal claims may not be combined with per diem for the same day.

6.4 On-site allowance

Employees in roles excluded from remote work under section 4.2 receive an on-site allowance of 180 currency units per month, paid with salary and subject to normal deductions.

7. Equipment and information security

7.1 Company equipment

Meridian Systems provides a laptop and, where the role requires it, a mobile handset. Laptops are refreshed on a 36-month cycle. Employees may purchase their retired laptop at its residual book value when the replacement is issued.

7.2 Security requirements

Use of the company password manager is mandatory for all work accounts. Multi-factor authentication must be enabled on every account that supports it. Reusing a work password on a personal service is a disciplinary matter.

Loss or theft of any device holding company data must be reported to the security team within 4 hours of discovery, at any hour of the day. Devices are remotely wiped as a matter of course; employees should not store personal data on company equipment.

7.3 Data handling

Customer telemetry data may not be copied to personal cloud storage, personal email, or unmanaged USB media under any circumstances. Where data must be shared with a third party, it is transferred through the managed file transfer service and the transfer is logged.

Firmware source code is classified as restricted. Restricted material may not leave the managed development environment, including on a personal device used for remote work.

7.4 Acceptable use

Incidental personal use of company equipment is permitted. Employees should have no expectation of privacy in relation to material stored on company systems, which may be accessed for legitimate business or investigatory purposes.

8. Performance, probation and leaving

8.1 Probation

New employees serve a probationary period of 90 days. During probation, either party may terminate the employment with 7 days notice. Probation may be extended once, by up to 60 days, where the manager documents specific objectives for the extension.

8.2 Performance reviews

Formal performance reviews take place twice yearly, in February and August. Salary adjustments arising from the February review take effect on 1 April. The August review is developmental and does not carry a salary decision.

8.3 Notice periods

Role	Notice from employee	Notice from company
Individual contributor	30 days	30 days
Manager	60 days	60 days
Director	90 days	90 days

8.4 Leaving the company

Accrued and unused annual leave is paid out on termination at the normal daily rate. Carried-over days that have already expired under section 5.1 are not paid. All company equipment must be returned on or before the final working day.

People Operations offers an exit interview to every departing employee. Participation is voluntary and the summary shared with the departing employee's manager is anonymised where the employee requests it.

9. Employee share scheme

Employees become eligible for the share scheme after 12 months of continuous service. Options vest over four years with a one-year cliff, and are exercisable for 90 days after the end of employment.